

Thomas Zijlstra, CFA

Financial Services Strategy, Transformation & Enterprise AI

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Work permit: EU · Switzerland · English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)

Zurich (2020-present) · London (2015-2020) · Paris (2013-2014)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Financial services professional with ten years of international experience across London, Zurich and Paris. Early career in FIG Debt Capital Markets at Societe Generale, covering DACH and Benelux financial institutions, followed by investment and financing work at a London family office. At Accenture in Zurich since 2020: regulated financial-services transformation (FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy, an OeNB central-bank audit stream, LIBOR transition), then enterprise AI strategy and workflow programmes. Currently leading the strategy, economics and pilot delivery of an AI-enabled regulatory-change workflow at a European reinsurer, and the Swiss NFR and AI capabilities team and its DACH go-to-market. CFA charterholder.

EXPERIENCE

> Accenture, Zurich Jun 2020 – Present

Financial Services AI & Digital Transformation

- Strategy, economics, roadmap and pilot delivery for an AI-enabled regulatory-change workflow at a European reinsurer, covering DORA, NIS2, EU AI Act and Solvency II.
- AI use-case and workflow shaping across RCSA, TPRM and regulatory change: translating business and control requirements into executable pilot designs with technical teams.
- Switzerland NFR Capabilities Team Lead: built and led the local AI and NFR practice, defining go-to-market for the DACH region within the CFO&EV division.
- Led origination and end-to-end delivery of a FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy programme at a Swiss insurer, including Databricks data-platform implementation.
- Stream Lead for an OeNB central-bank audit at a European core banking provider.
- LIBOR and interest-rate-transition delivery at a European GSIB, drawing on capital-markets experience across derivatives, valuation, and trading-desk structures.
- Coordination across CRO, COO, risk, data, technology, governance, and regulatory stakeholders in regulated financial-services environments.

• Single Family Office, London Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

Investment & Finance Manager

- Company valuation and cash-flow modelling.
- Direct-investment and financing analysis.
- Debt, asset-backed, and equity-financing discussions.
- Engagement with investors, portfolio companies, and financing counterparties.
- Work in an entrepreneurial, growth-stage environment.

Societe Generale, **London** Jun 2015 – Jul 2018

Debt Capital Markets Analyst, FIG | DACH and Benelux (selected UK/Ireland)

- DCM origination, structuring, and execution.
- Senior, Tier 2, covered, RMBS, subordinated, and green-bond products.
- Capital-markets reporting, credit work, liquidity analysis, capacity analysis.
- Coordination with M&A, ECM, Legal, Syndication.
- Derivatives, structured products, IRS, FX options, structured notes.

Catalina, **Paris** Jun 2013 – Jan 2014

Data Scientist (Traineeship)

- Consumer and purchasing-behaviour analysis.
- Statistical analysis of transaction data.
- Price-elasticity and product-portfolio analysis.
- Translation of analytical findings into client recommendations.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Enterprise NFR Work Fabric | Case study

Private blueprint and interactive experience, sanitised

- A strategic, operating-model, architecture and experience blueprint for connected non-financial-risk work across eight process families, built as a 22-scene interactive executive experience with explorer deep dives, acceptance tests and accessibility checks.
- Commercial relevance: Replaces isolated AI use cases with one persistent work object, permissioned role views and a shared, governed fabric, with a federated operating model and a roadmap that grows by process cluster.
- Synthetic scenarios only; client identity and internal materials excluded. A blueprint, not a deployed system.

Enterprise AI Economics Simulator | Case study

Interactive decision tool, AI-assisted prototype

- Executive cost model for a shared AI platform: allocation across the functions sharing it, maturity, hosting, governance staffing, licences and usage, with a ten-year cash flow and break-even.
- Commercial relevance: At its illustrative defaults, fixed platform and governance costs are about 96 percent of year-one cost and tokens under 1 percent, which moves the business case from token prices to sharing, maturity and hosting.
- Illustrative planning assumptions and placeholder benchmarks. Not a client tool, a proposal or a production system.

DORA Article 12 AI Control Line | Case study

Working workflow prototype, AI-assisted

- Takes one regulatory obligation through guideline, control, infrastructure proposal, policy verification, documentation and evidence, with an explicit state machine, three human approval gates and hash-linked provenance.
- Commercial relevance: Shows how regulatory change can stay traceable and human-approved end to end, with task-based model assignment and deterministic verification before review.
- Synthetic fixtures; cloud, deployment and register integrations simulated; client context excluded.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

CFA Charterholder
CFA Institute

MSc Finance and Investments 2014 – 2015
Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University
Cum laude · 8.5/10
Thesis: "Credit rating changes and their effect on asymmetric information"

BSc International Business Administration 2011 – 2014
Rotterdam School of Management
Honours · 8.1/10

CAPABILITIES

Commercialisation and market building

AI go-to-market · opportunity qualification · customer discovery · C-suite engagement · proposition development · pilot commercialisation · partner and ecosystem strategy · adoption and expansion · financial and revenue modelling

Enterprise AI value engineering

use-case prioritisation · workflow and operating-model design · business-case development · pilot scope and success criteria · model and workflow evaluation · human oversight · governance and controls · deployment and rollout planning

Applied technical fluency

agent workflow concepts · API and enterprise integration requirements · data and knowledge architecture concepts · model evaluation and routing · human approval patterns · AI-assisted prototyping · cloud deployment patterns

Financial services

FIG and capital markets · Non-Financial Risk · RCSA and TPRM · DORA and AI governance · regulatory reporting · data adequacy · investment and financing analysis